Superstore Sales Performance Dashboard using Tableau

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1. Introduction

This report explores the sales and profit performance of a U.S.-based Superstore by leveraging Tableau for data visualization and analysis. The dataset, covering transactions from 2014 to 2018, includes detailed information on customer orders, regional sales, product categories, and financial metrics. The primary objective is to uncover trends, identify top- and bottom-performing regions and products, and provide strategic insights for business decision-making.

Through an interactive Tableau dashboard, the analysis highlights strong sales and profitability in the West and East regions, while exposing underperformance and instability in the Central and South regions. Product-level insights further reveal a consistent demand for office equipment across regions, as well as the declining relevance of outdated or commoditized products.

A particularly notable finding is the sudden profit drop in 2018 across all regions, prompting questions about operational costs or external market disruptions. Based on these insights, the report proposes targeted strategies to enhance regional performance, optimize inventory, and strengthen profitability.

2. Dataset Overview

The dataset used in this analysis is sourced from Kaggle, available at:
[https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/vivek468/superstore-dataset-final](https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/vivek468/superstore-dataset-final?select=Sample+-+Superstore.csv)

This Superstore dataset was originally featured on the Tableau website and is intended for educational and analytical purposes. It represents transactional data from a global retail superstore, capturing customer orders between 2014 and 2018.

The dataset includes detailed information across various dimensions such as:

Customer information (ID, Name, Segment, Region, State, City),
Order details (Order ID, Order Date, Ship Date, Ship Mode),
Product details (Product ID, Category, Sub-Category, Product Name),
And financial metrics like Sales, Quantity, Discount, and Profit.

With over 9,900 records, this dataset offers rich opportunities for business insights — particularly in identifying profitable product categories, customer segments, and regional performance patterns. It also serves as a strong base for predictive modeling tasks such as regression on Sales or Profit.

Note: The dataset is publicly shared for learning and analysis purposes. Full credit belongs to the original authors from Tableau.

To provide a better understanding of the dataset structure, a sample of the data is shown below. This excerpt includes key variables such as order details, customer information, and transaction metrics like sales and profit,...

Row ID	Order ID	Order Date	Ship Date	Ship Mode	Customer ID	Customer Na	Segment	Country	City	State
1	CA-2016-152	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Claire Gute	Consumer	United State	Henderson	Kentucky
2	CA-2016-152	11/8/2016	11/11/2016	Second Class	CG-12520	Claire Gute	Consumer	United State	Henderson	Kentucky
3	CA-2016-138	6/12/2016	6/16/2016	Second Class	DV-13045	Darrin Van H	Corporate	United State	Los Angeles	California
4	US-2015-108	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Cla	SO-20335	Sean O'Donn	Consumer	United State	Fort Lauderd	Florida
5	US-2015-108	10/11/2015	10/18/2015	Standard Cla	SO-20335	Sean O'Donn	Consumer	United State	Fort Lauderd	Florida
6	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
7	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
8	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
9	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
10	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
11	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
12	CA-2014-115	6/9/2014	6/14/2014	Standard Cla	BH-11710	Brosina Hoff	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
13	CA-2017-114	4/15/2017	4/20/2017	Standard Cla	AA-10480	Andrew Alle	Consumer	United State	Concord	North Carolir
14	CA-2016-161	12/5/2016	12/10/2016	Standard Cla	IM-15070	Irene Maddo	Consumer	United State	Seattle	Washington
15	US-2015-118	11/22/2015	11/26/2015	Standard Cla	HP-14815	Harold Pawl	Home Office	United State	Fort Worth	Texas
16	US-2015-118	11/22/2015	11/26/2015	Standard Cla	HP-14815	Harold Pawl	Home Office	United State	Fort Worth	Texas
17	CA-2014-105	11/11/2014	11/18/2014	Standard Cla	PK-19075	Pete Kriz	Consumer	United State	Madison	Wisconsin
18	CA-2014-167	5/13/2014	5/15/2014	Second Class	AG-10270	Alejandro Gr	Consumer	United State	West Jordan	Utah
19	CA-2014-143	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Do	Consumer	United State	San Francisc	California
20	CA-2014-143	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Do	Consumer	United State	San Francisc	California
21	CA-2014-143	8/27/2014	9/1/2014	Second Class	ZD-21925	Zuschuss Do	Consumer	United State	San Francisc	California
22	CA-2016-137	12/9/2016	12/13/2016	Standard Cla	KB-16585	Ken Black	Corporate	United State	Fremont	Nebraska
23	CA-2016-137	12/9/2016	12/13/2016	Standard Cla	KB-16585	Ken Black	Corporate	United State	Fremont	Nebraska
24	US-2017-156	7/16/2017	7/18/2017	Second Class	SF-20065	Sandra Flan	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
25	CA-2015-106	9/25/2015	9/30/2015	Standard Cla	EB-13870	Emily Burns	Consumer	United State	Orem	Utah
26	CA-2016-121	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	Eric Hoffmar	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
27	CA-2016-121	1/16/2016	1/20/2016	Second Class	EH-13945	Eric Hoffmar	Consumer	United State	Los Angeles	California
28	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
29	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
30	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
31	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
32	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
33	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
34	US-2015-150	9/17/2015	9/21/2015	Standard Cla	TB-21520	Tracy Blumst	Consumer	United State	Philadelphia	Pennsylvania
35	CA-2017-107	10/19/2017	10/23/2017	Second Class	MA-17560	Matt Abelm	Home Office	United State	Houston	Texas
36	CA-2016-117	12/8/2016	12/10/2016	First Class	GH-14485	Gene Hale	Corporate	United State	Richardson	Texas
37	CA-2016-117	12/8/2016	12/10/2016	First Class	GH-14485	Gene Hale	Corporate	United State	Richardson	Texas
38	CA-2015-117	12/27/2015	12/31/2015	Standard Cla	SN-20710	Steve Nguye	Home Office	United State	Houston	Texas

Row ID	Postal Code	Region	Product ID	Category	Sub-Categor	Product Nam	Sales	Quantity	Discount	Profit
1	42420	South	FUR-BO-100	Furniture	Bookcases	Bush Somers	261.96	2	0	41.9136
2	42420	South	FUR-CH-100	Furniture	Chairs	Hon Deluxe F	731.94	3	0	219.582
3	90036	West	OFF-LA-100	Office Suppli	Labels	Self-Adhesiv	14.62	2	0	6.8714
4	33311	South	FUR-TA-100	Furniture	Tables	Bretford CR4	957.5775	5	0.45	-383.031
5	33311	South	OFF-ST-100	Office Suppli	Storage	Eldon Fold 'N	22.368	2	0.2	2.5164
6	90032	West	FUR-FU-100	Furniture	Furnishings	Eldon Expres	48.86	7	0	14.1694
7	90032	West	OFF-AR-100	Office Suppli	Art	Newell 322	7.28	4	0	1.9656
8	90032	West	TEC-PH-1000	Technology	Phones	Mitel 5320 IF	907.152	6	0.2	90.7152
9	90032	West	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	DXL Angle-Vi	18.504	3	0.2	5.7825
10	90032	West	OFF-AP-100	Office Suppli	Appliances	Belkin F5C20	114.9	5	0	34.47
11	90032	West	FUR-TA-100	Furniture	Tables	Chromcraft F	1706.184	9	0.2	85.3092
12	90032	West	TEC-PH-1000	Technology	Phones	Konftel 250 (	911.424	4	0.2	68.3568
13	28027	South	OFF-PA-100	Office Suppli	Paper	Xerox 1967	15.552	3	0.2	5.4432
14	98103	West	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Fellowes PB	407.976	3	0.2	132.5922
15	76106	Central	OFF-AP-100	Office Suppli	Appliances	Holmes Repl	68.81	5	0.8	-123.858
16	76106	Central	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Storex DuraT	2.544	3	0.8	-3.816
17	53711	Central	OFF-ST-100	Office Suppli	Storage	Stur-D-Stor S	665.88	6	0	13.3176
18	84084	West	OFF-ST-100	Office Suppli	Storage	Fellowes Sup	55.5	2	0	9.99
19	94109	West	OFF-AR-100	Office Suppli	Art	Newell 341	8.56	2	0	2.4824
20	94109	West	TEC-PH-1000	Technology	Phones	Cisco SPA 50	213.48	3	0.2	16.011
21	94109	West	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Wilson Jones	22.72	4	0.2	7.384
22	68025	Central	OFF-AR-100	Office Suppli	Art	Newell 318	19.46	7	0	5.0596
23	68025	Central	OFF-AP-100	Office Suppli	Appliances	Acco Six-Out	60.34	7	0	15.6884
24	19140	East	FUR-CH-100	Furniture	Chairs	Global Delux	71.372	2	0.3	-1.0196
25	84057	West	FUR-TA-100	Furniture	Tables	Bretford CR4	1044.63	3	0	240.2649
26	90049	West	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Wilson Jones	11.648	2	0.2	4.2224
27	90049	West	TEC-AC-1000	Technology	Accessories	Imation†8GE	90.57	3	0	11.7741
28	19140	East	FUR-BO-100	Furniture	Bookcases	Riverside Pal	3083.43	7	0.5	-1665.0522
29	19140	East	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Avery Recycl	9.618	2	0.7	-7.0532
30	19140	East	FUR-FU-100	Furniture	Furnishings	Howard Mill	124.2	3	0.2	15.525
31	19140	East	OFF-EN-100	Office Suppli	Envelopes	Poly String T	3.264	2	0.2	1.1016
32	19140	East	OFF-AR-100	Office Suppli	Art	BOSTON Mo	86.304	6	0.2	9.7092
33	19140	East	OFF-BI-1000	Office Suppli	Binders	Acco Pressbc	6.858	6	0.7	-5.715
34	19140	East	OFF-AR-100	Office Suppli	Art	Lumber Cray	15.76	2	0.2	3.546
35	77095	Central	OFF-PA-100	Office Suppli	Paper	Easy-staple p	29.472	3	0.2	9.9468
36	75080	Central	TEC-PH-1000	Technology	Phones	GE 30524EE	1097.544	7	0.2	123.4737
37	75080	Central	FUR-FU-100	Furniture	Furnishings	Electrix Arch	190.92	5	0.6	-147.963
38	77041	Central	OFF-EN-100	Office Suppli	Envelopes	#10-4 1/8" x	113.328	9	0.2	35.415

Figure 1: Sample of the Superstore Dataset Table

3. Sales Performance Analysis

3.1 Sales Distribution by Region

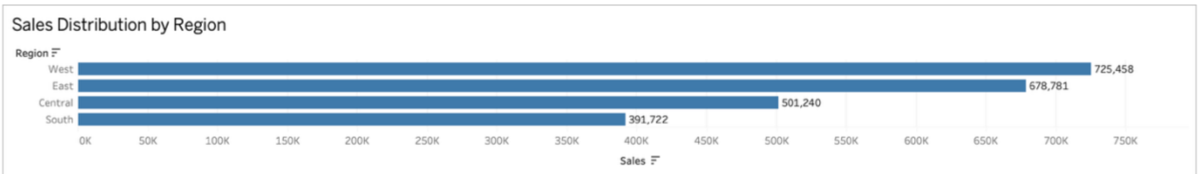

Figure 2: Sales Distribution by Region

Based on the "Sales Distribution by Region" chart, the West posts the highest sales at approximately $725,458, followed closely by the East at $678,781. The Central region delivers a moderate $501,240, while the South lags behind with just $391,722. These figures confirm that the West and East are the company's primary revenue engines, reflecting a stronger market presence and customer base in those areas. Accordingly, strategic initiatives should prioritise boosting sales in the South to narrow regional performance gaps.

3.2 Sales Distribution by State

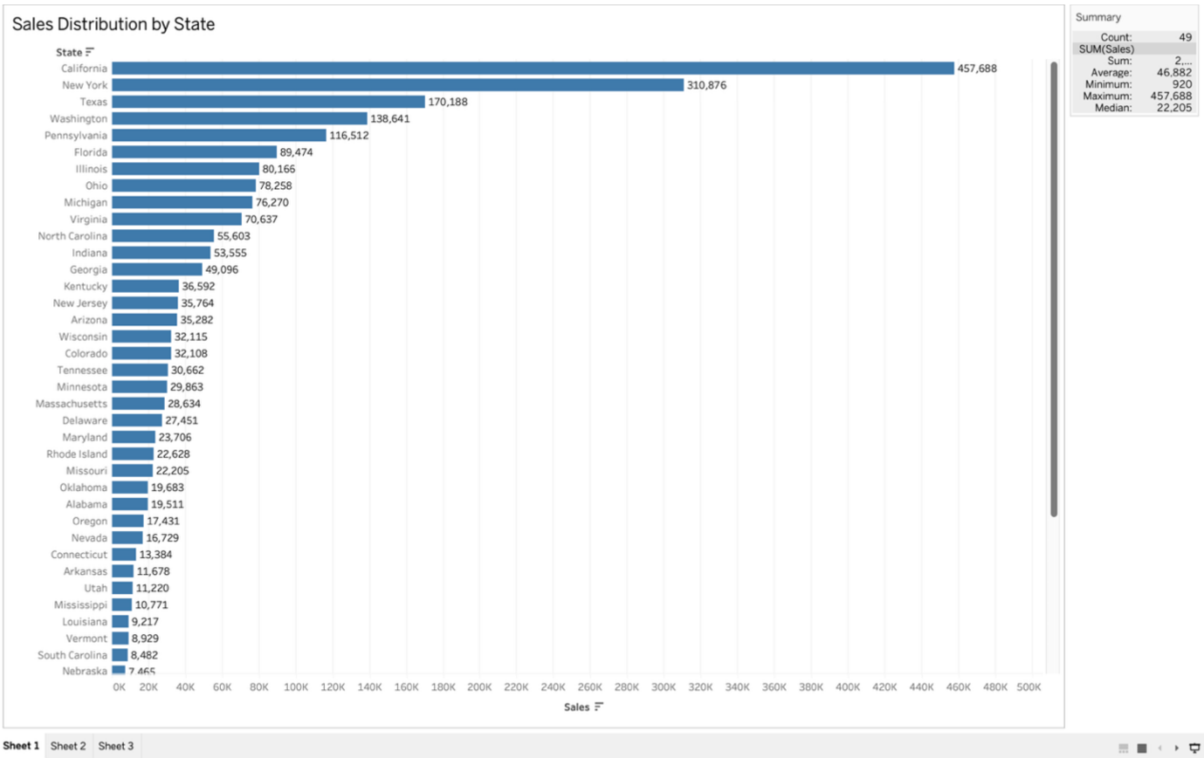

Figure 3: Sales Distribution by State

Based on the “Sales Distribution by State” chart, California leads by a wide margin with $457,688 in sales, significantly outperforming all other states. New York and Texas follow with $310,876 and $170,188, respectively, while Washington ranks fourth at $138,641. These top four states account for a substantial portion of total sales, indicating concentrated market activity in major economic hubs.

The remaining states show a gradual decline in sales, with many generating under $100,000. States like Pennsylvania, Florida, and Illinois still perform strongly, but there is a noticeable sales gap compared to the top tier. On the other end of the spectrum, states such as Nebraska, South Carolina, and Vermont report the lowest sales figures, under $10,000, highlighting regional underperformance or smaller market presence.

This distribution suggests that business operations and customer engagement are highly centralized in a few high-performing states. Strategic expansion efforts could focus on underpenetrated states to diversify revenue sources and reduce overreliance on a handful of markets.

3.3 States by Sales in the Central Region

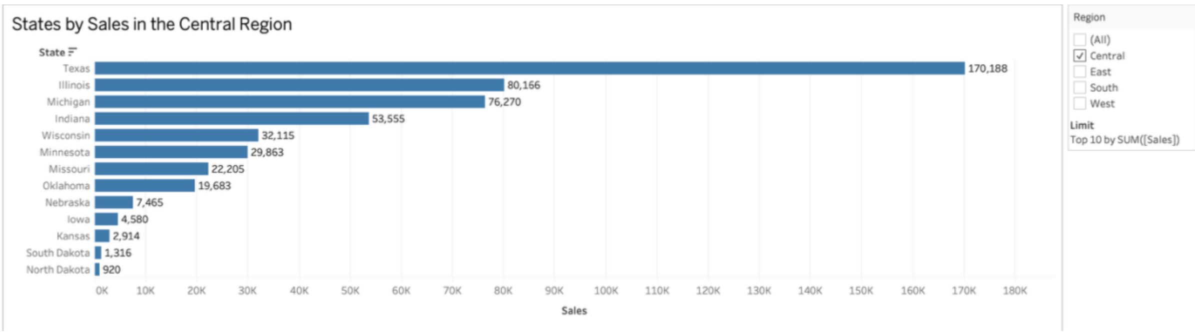

Figure 4: States by Sales in the Central Region

Based on the "States by Sales in the Central Region" chart, Texas stands out as the dominant contributor, generating $170,188 in sales—more than double the next highest-performing states, Illinois ($80,166) and Michigan ($76,270). These three states form the backbone of Central region revenue, showcasing significantly stronger market performance compared to others.

Sales then decline moderately through states like Indiana ($53,555), Wisconsin ($32,115), and Minnesota ($29,863), indicating a second-tier group with steady but lower sales figures. At the bottom, North Dakota ($920), South Dakota ($1,316), and Kansas ($2,914) contribute minimally to overall revenue, highlighting a disparity within the region.

This distribution underscores the heavy reliance on a few key states—particularly Texas—for Central region sales. To strengthen overall regional performance, strategic efforts could aim at improving market penetration in the lower-performing states through targeted campaigns or infrastructure improvements.

3.4 States by Sales in the East Region

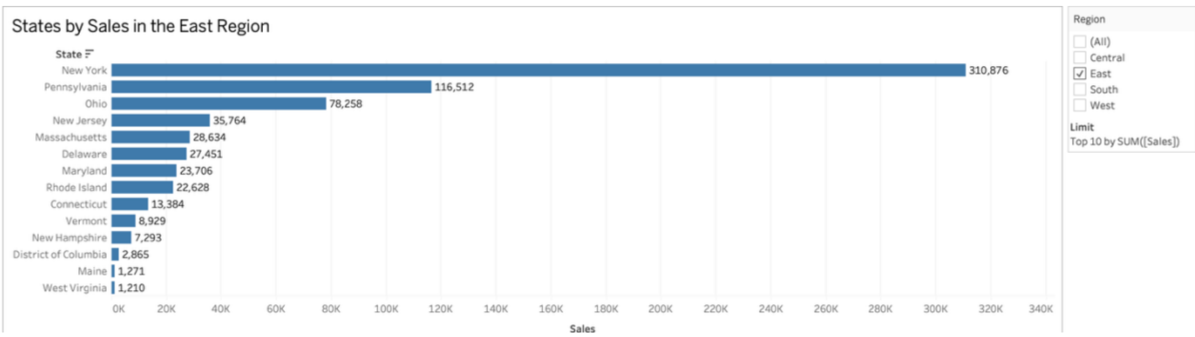

Figure 5: States by Sales in the East Region

Based on the "States by Sales in the East Region" chart, New York overwhelmingly leads in sales performance with $310,876, significantly outpacing all other states in the region. Pennsylvania and Ohio follow with $116,512 and $78,258 respectively, forming a high-performing trio that contributes substantially to the region's total sales.

Further down the list, mid-tier states like New Jersey ($35,764), Massachusetts ($28,634), Delaware ($27,451), and Maryland ($23,706) exhibit steady but comparatively moderate sales figures. In contrast, the bottom-tier states—such as District of Columbia ($2,865), Maine ($1,271), and West Virginia

($1,210)—show very limited sales, indicating either market saturation, smaller customer bases, or untapped potential.

This sales distribution highlights a significant gap between top and bottom contributors in the East, suggesting that while major states like New York drive the region's performance, targeted strategies in underperforming states may unlock new growth opportunities and balance overall contribution.

3.5 States by Sales in the South Region

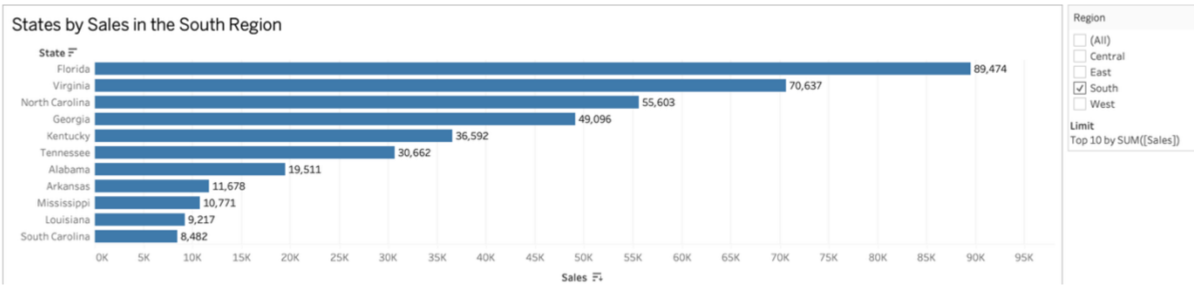

Figure 6: States by Sales in the South Region

Based on the "States by Sales in the South Region" chart, Florida leads the region with the highest sales, reaching $89,474, followed by Virginia at $70,637 and North Carolina at $55,603. These three states stand out as the major contributors to the South's overall revenue.

In the mid-tier range, Georgia ($49,096), Kentucky ($36,592), and Tennessee ($30,662) show moderate sales performance, reflecting a healthy but less dominant role in the region's sales profile.

On the lower end of the spectrum, states like Alabama ($19,511), Arkansas ($11,678), Mississippi ($10,771), Louisiana ($9,217), and South Carolina ($8,482) lag behind significantly. This gap between the top-performing and bottom-performing states suggests an uneven distribution of market activity within the South.

To improve the region's overall sales performance, targeted marketing, sales strategies, or infrastructure investments could be considered in the underperforming states, leveraging the success of stronger states as a model.

3.6 States by Sales in the West Region

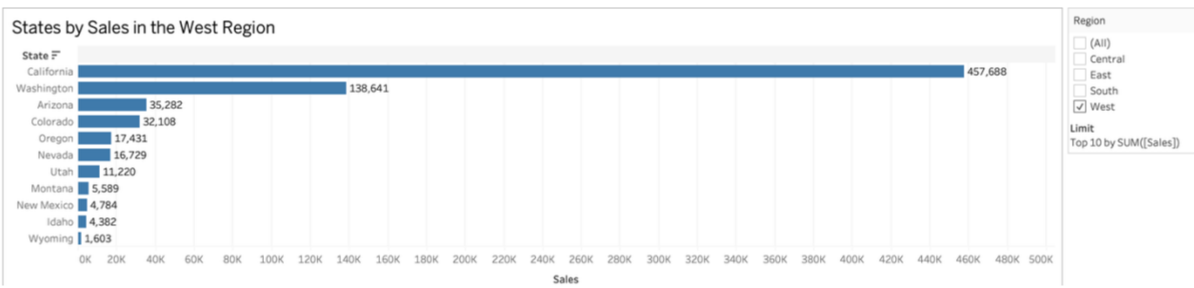

Figure 7: States by Sales in the West Region

Based on the "States by Sales in the West Region" chart, California stands out as the dominant contributor, generating $457,688 in sales — more than triple that of the next-highest state, Washington, which recorded $138,641. These two states clearly anchor the region's revenue stream.

In the mid-tier range, Arizona ($35,282) and Colorado ($32,108) contribute moderately, while states like Oregon ($17,431), Nevada ($16,729), and Utah ($11,220) show relatively lower but still notable performance.

At the lower end, states such as Montana ($5,589), New Mexico ($4,784), Idaho ($4,382), and Wyoming ($1,603) exhibit minimal sales impact.

This stark contrast underscores California's critical role in the West's market success. Strategic expansion and resource allocation in mid- and low-performing states could help balance revenue and reduce reliance on a single high-performing state.

4. Product Sales Analysis by Revenue and Region.

4.1 Top Best-Selling Products in the United States and Its Regions

4.1.1 Top-selling products with sales over $10,000 across the United States

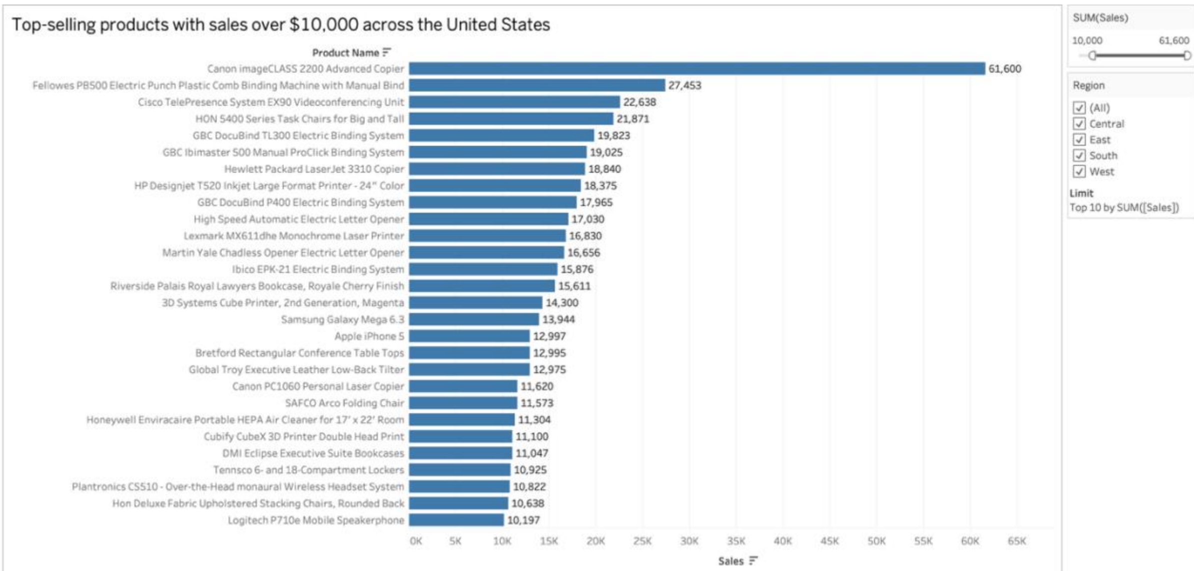

Figure 8: Top-selling products with sales over $10,000 across the United States

4.1.2 Top 10 best-selling items per region

4.1.2.1 Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the Central Region of the United States

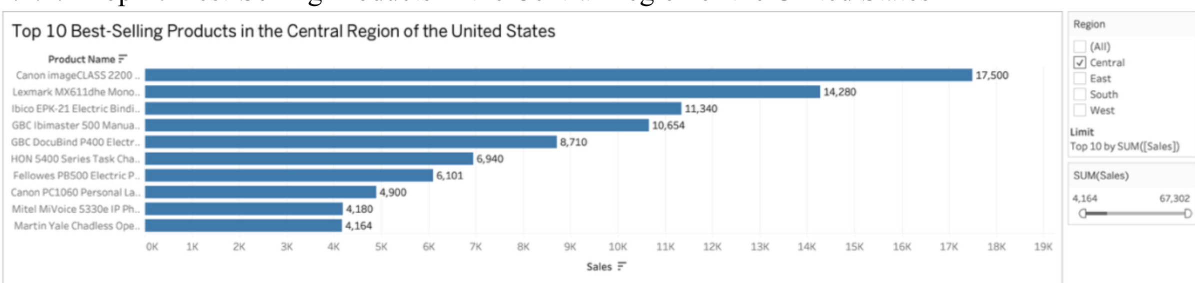

Figure 9: Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the Central Region of the United States

4.1.2.2 Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the East Region of the United States

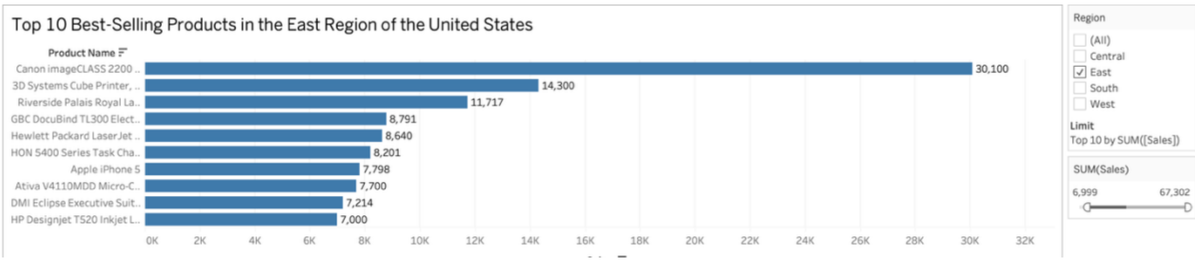

Figure 10: Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the East Region of the United States

4.1.2.3 Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the South Region of the United States

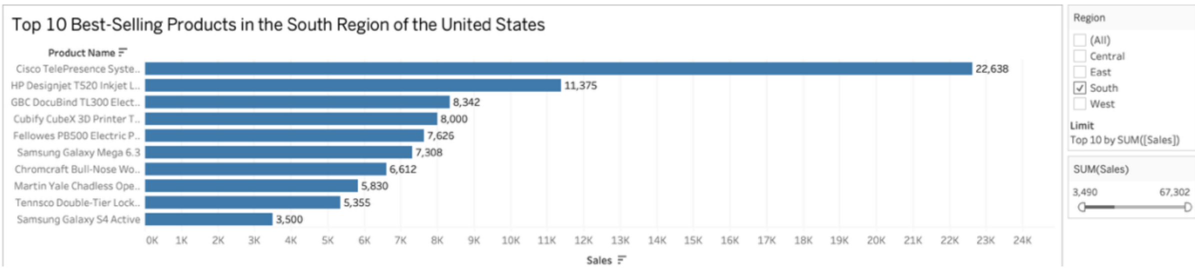

Figure 11: Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the South Region of the United States

4.1.2.4 Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the West Region of the United States

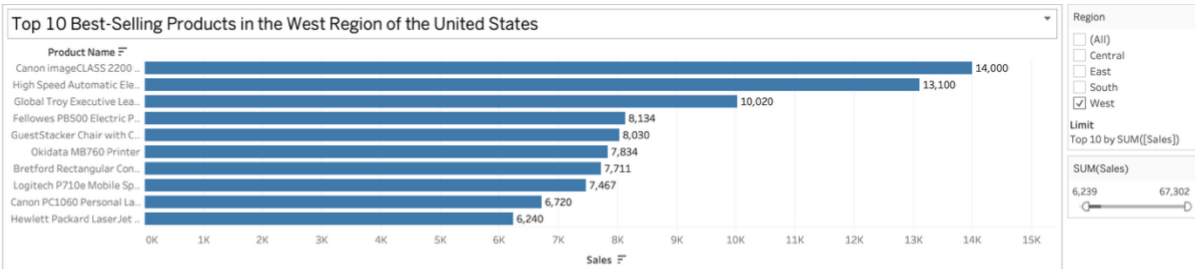

Figure 12: Top 10 Best-Selling Products in the West Region of the United States

4.1.2.5 Summary of Top-Selling Products Across the United States and Its Regions

Table 1: Summary of Top-Selling Products Across the United States and Its Regions

No	Top 10 – USA	Top 10 – Central Region	Top 10 – East Region	Top 10 – South Region	Top 10 – West Region
1	Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	Cisco TelePresence System EX90 Videoconferencing Unit	Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier
2	Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine with Manual Bind	Lexmark MX611dhe Monochrome Laser Printer	3D Systems Cube Printer, 2nd Generation, Magenta	HP Designjet T520 Inkjet Large Format Printer - 24" Color	High Speed Automatic Electric Letter Opener
3	Cisco TelePresence System EX90 Videoconferencing Unit	Ibico EPK-21 Electric Binding System	Riverside Palais Royal Lawyers Bookcase, Royale Cherry Finish	GBC DocuBind TL300 Electric Binding System	Global Troy Executive Leather Low-Back Tilter
4	HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall	GBC Ibimaster 500 Manual ProClick Binding System	GBC DocuBind TL300 Electric Binding System	Cubify CubeX 3D Printer Triple Head Print	Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine with Manual Bind
5	GBC DocuBind TL300 Electric Binding System	GBC DocuBind P400 Electric Binding System	Hewlett Packard LaserJet 3310 Copier	Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine with Manual Bind	GuestStacker Chair with Chrome Finish Legs
6	GBC Ibimaster 500 Manual ProClick Binding System	HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall	HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall	Samsung Galaxy Mega 6.3	Okidata MB760 Printer
7	Hewlett Packard LaserJet 3310 Copier	Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine with Manual Bind	Apple iPhone 5	Chromcraft Bull-Nose Wood Oval Conference Tables & Bases	Bretford Rectangular Conference Table Tops
8	HP Designjet T520 Inkjet Large Format Printer - 24" Color	Canon PC1060 Personal Laser Copier	Ativa V4110MDD Micro-Cut Shredder	Martin Yale Chadless Opener Electric Letter Opener	Logitech P710e Mobile Speakerphone
9	GBC DocuBind P400 Electric Binding System	Mitel MiVoice 5330e IP Phone	DMI Eclipse Executive Suite Bookcases	Tennsco Double-Tier Lockers	Canon PC1060 Personal Laser Copier
10	High Speed Automatic Electric Letter Opener	Martin Yale Chadless Opener Electric Letter Opener	HP Designjet T520 Inkjet Large Format Printer - 24" Color	Samsung Galaxy S4 Active	Hewlett Packard LaserJet 3310 Copier

The analysis of the top 10 best-selling products across the United States and its four major regions—Central, East, South, and West—reveals both national consistencies and regional differences in purchasing patterns. One standout product is the Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier, which appears in the top 1 position in the USA, Central, East, and West regions, highlighting its strong nationwide appeal, likely due to its broad functionality and relevance across industries.

Table 2: Products Appearing in Multiple Regions

Product Name	Regions Appeared	Times Ranked
Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	USA, Central, East, West	4
Fellowes PB500 Electric Binding Machine	USA, Central, South, West	4
HP Designjet T520 Inkjet Large Format Printer – 24” Color	USA, South, East, West	4
HON 5400 Series Task Chairs for Big and Tall	USA, Central, East	3
Hewlett Packard LaserJet 3310 Copier	USA, East, West	3
GBC DocuBind TL300 Electric Binding System	USA, East, South	3

These top-ranked items represent cross-regional demand for reliable office equipment—particularly printers, copiers, and binding machines. Their recurrence across multiple markets suggests a stable need in both business and education sectors.

Despite national overlaps, each region also demonstrates unique preferences. For example, the East Region includes items like the Apple iPhone 5 and 3D Systems Cube Printer, suggesting a tilt towards consumer electronics and emerging tech tools. In contrast, the South Region features the Samsung Galaxy Mega 6.3 and Cisco TelePresence System EX90, highlighting preferences for communication and mobile devices, perhaps due to hybrid work trends or regional business needs.

The West Region shows more emphasis on workplace comfort and technology, with items such as the Global Troy Executive Leather Chair, GuestStacker Chair, and Logitech P710e Mobile Speakerphone.

Table 3: Unique Products by Region

Region	Unique Products (Examples)
East	Apple iPhone 5, 3D Systems Cube Printer, Ativa Micro-Cut Shredder
South	Samsung Galaxy Mega 6.3, Cisco TelePresence EX90, Chromcraft Conference Tables

West	GuestStacker Chair, Global Troy Leather Chair, Logitech P710e Speakerphone, Okidata Printer
Central	Lexmark Laser Printer, Mitel IP Phone, Canon PC1060 Personal Copier

These region-specific entries suggest variations in consumer behavior and institutional needs. For example, Southern and Western regions show higher interest in meeting/communication tools, while the East leans into compact tech and shredders, potentially indicating urban office constraints.

While a few high-performing products dominate nationally, the regional data provides valuable insights into localized demands and purchasing behaviors—crucial for targeted marketing, regional inventory management, and strategic decision-making in supply chain operations.

4.2 Least-Selling Products in the United States and Its Regions

4.2.1 Bottom-selling products across the United States

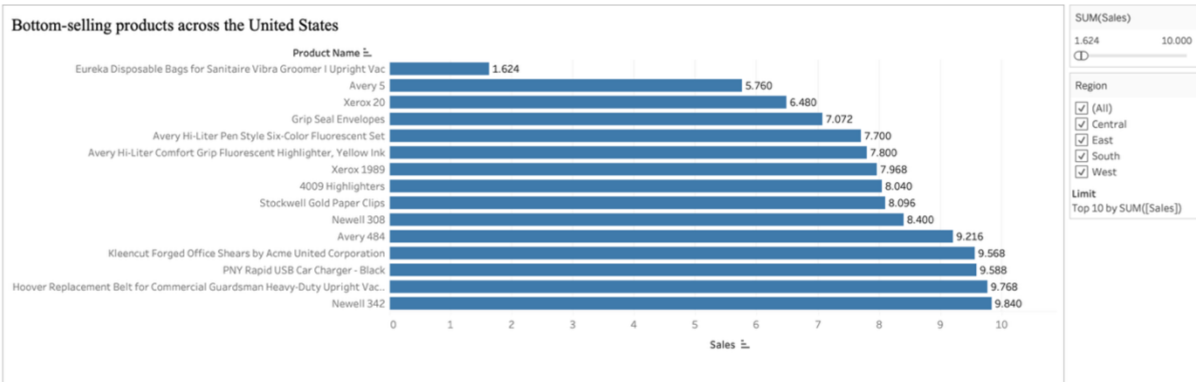

Figure 13: Bottom-selling products across the United States (under 10USD)

4.2.2 Bottom 10 least-selling items per region
4.2.2.1 Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the Central Region of the United States

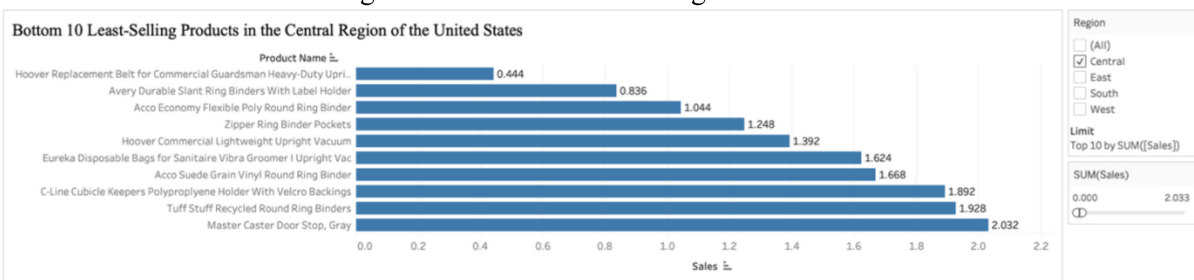

Figure 14: Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the Central Region of the United States

4.2.2.2 Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the East Region of the United States

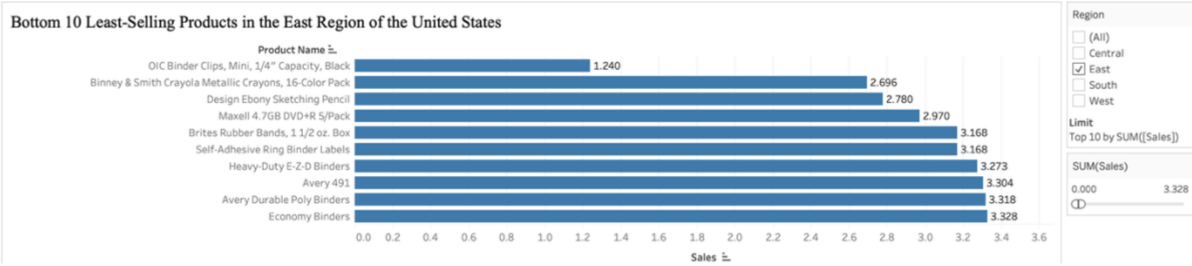

Figure 15: Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the East Region of the United States

4.2.2.3 Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the South Region of the United States

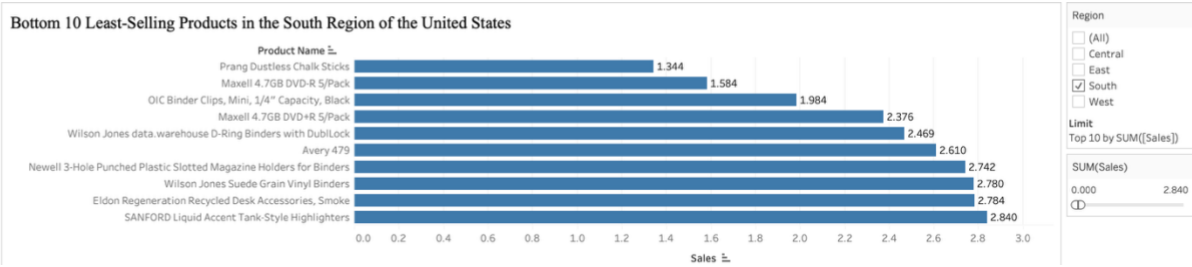

Figure 16: Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the South Region of the United States

4.2.2.4 Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the West Region of the United States

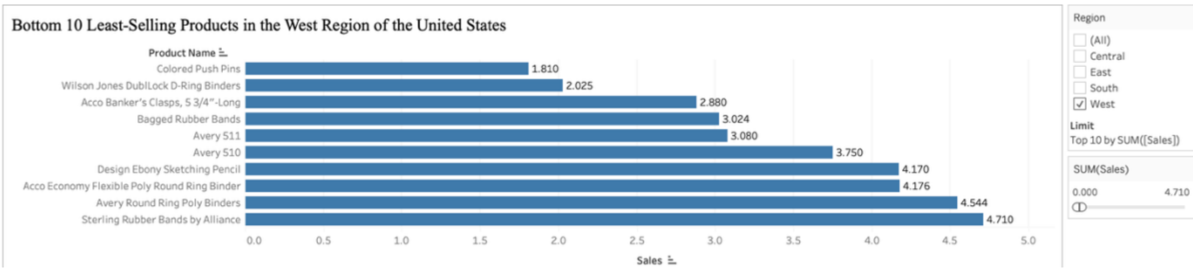

Figure 17: Bottom 10 Least-Selling Products in the West Region of the United States

4.2.2.5 Summary of Least-Selling Products Across the United States and Its Regions

Table 4: Summary of Least-Selling Products Across the United States and Its Regions

No	Bottom 10 – USA	Bottom 10 – Central Region	Bottom 10 – East Region	Bottom 10 – South Region	Bottom 10 – West Region
1	Eureka Disposable Bags for Sanitaire Vibra Groomer I Upright Vac	Hoover Replacement Belt for Commercial Guardsman Heavy-Duty Upright Vacuum	OIC Binder Clips, Mini, 1/4" Capacity, Black	Prang Dustless Chalk Sticks	Colored Push Pins
2	Avery 5	Avery Durable Slant Ring Binders With Label Holder	Binney & Smith Crayola Metallic Crayons, 16-Color Pack	Maxell 4.7GB DVD-R 5/Pack	Wilson Jones DublLock D-Ring Binders
3	Xerox 20	Acco Economy Flexible Poly Round Ring Binder	Design Ebony Sketching Pencil	OIC Binder Clips, Mini, 1/4" Capacity, Black	Acco Banker's Clasps, 5 3/4"-Long
4	Grip Seal Envelopes	Zipper Ring Binder Pockets	Maxell 4.7GB DVD+R 5/Pack	Maxell 4.7GB DVD+R 5/Pack	Bagged Rubber Bands
5	Avery Hi-Liter Pen Style Six-Color Fluorescent Set	Hoover Commercial Lightweight Upright Vacuum	Self-Adhesive Ring Binder Labels	Wilson Jones data.warehouse D-Ring Binders with DublLock	Avery 511
6	Avery Hi-Liter Comfort Grip Fluorescent Highlighter, Yellow Ink	Eureka Disposable Bags for Sanitaire Vibra Groomer I Upright Vac	Brites Rubber Bands, 1 1/2 oz. Box	Avery 479	Avery 510
7	Xerox 1989	Acco Suede Grain Vinyl Round Ring Binder	Heavy-Duty E-Z-D Binders	Newell 3-Hole Punched Plastic Slotted Magazine Holders for Binders	Design Ebony Sketching Pencil
8	4009 Highlighters	C-Line Cubicle Keepers Polyproplyene Holder With Velcro Backings	Avery 491	Wilson Jones Suede Grain Vinyl Binders	Acco Economy Flexible Poly Round Ring Binder
9	Stockwell Gold Paper Clips	Tuff Stuff Recycled Round Ring Binders	Avery Durable Poly Binders	Eldon Regeneration Recycled Desk Accessories, Smoke	Avery Round Ring Poly Binders
10	Newell 308	Master Caster Door Stop, Gray	Economy Binders	SANFORD Liquid Accent Tank-Style Highlighters	Sterling Rubber Bands by Alliance

The table highlights the bottom 10 least-selling products across the United States and its four major regions—Central, East, South, and West. Unlike the top-selling list, the bottom-selling products are more fragmented and highly localized, with little consistency across regions. These products typically include low-cost, low-volume office supplies, outdated media storage formats, and niche items.

Table 5: Products Appearing in Multiple Regions

Product Name	Regions Appeared	Times Ranked
Maxell 4.7GB DVD+R / DVD-R (various packs)	Central, East, South	3
Avery Highlighters & Binders (various SKUs: 5, 479, 491, 510)	USA, Central, East, West	4+
Eureka Disposable Vacuum Bags	USA, Central	2
OIC Binder Clips (Mini, 1/4")	East, South	2
Acco Ring Binders & Clasps (various types)	Central, West	2

These items consistently show low demand across multiple markets, often because they belong to outdated categories (e.g., DVD media, rubber bands, chalk) or commoditized stationery (e.g., binder clips, basic paper binders) with declining relevance in modern workplaces.

Regional Observations

Central Region: Shows an overrepresentation of ring binders, binders pockets, and vacuum accessories, possibly indicating oversupply or low replacement frequency in offices.

East Region: Includes arts & school supplies like Crayola crayons, sketch pencils, and chalk sticks, suggesting that these products may be misaligned with the actual demand in East coast businesses.

South Region: Contains media-related products (e.g., DVD+R packs), and desk accessories (e.g., slotted magazine holders), which may have been phased out due to digitalization or minimal use in hybrid workplaces.

West Region: Displays the greatest diversity of low-performing items including rubber bands, plastic binders, highlight markers, and suede vinyl folders, potentially reflecting more environmentally conscious or tech-oriented consumer habits.

Table 6: Categories Frequently Found in Bottom 10

Product Category	Examples	Appears In
Legacy Media Storage	Maxell DVD-R/DVD+R	Central, East, South
Basic Office Stationery	Binder Clips, Rubber Bands, Door Stops	All regions
Outdated Presentation Tools	Chalk, Hi-Lighters, Binder Labels	USA, East, West
Binders & Filing Supplies	Acco, Avery, Wilson Jones Binders	All regions

The bottom 10 product lists reveal that low demand is concentrated around outdated, commoditized, or low-utility items. Many of these products may no longer fit the needs of digital-first offices, hybrid work environments, or modern classrooms. This presents an opportunity for companies to reassess inventory priorities, reduce procurement in these categories, and shift focus to higher-value or more versatile alternatives.

5. Total Revenue and Profit

5.1 Top 10 States with the Highest Profit

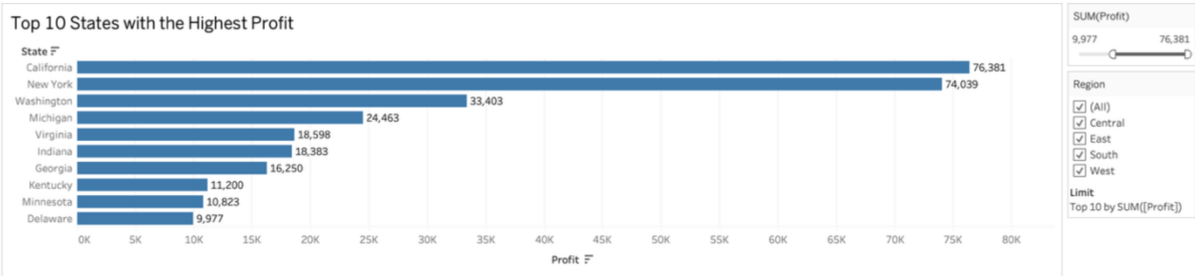

Figure 18: Top 10 States with the Highest Profit

5.2 States with the Lowest Profit

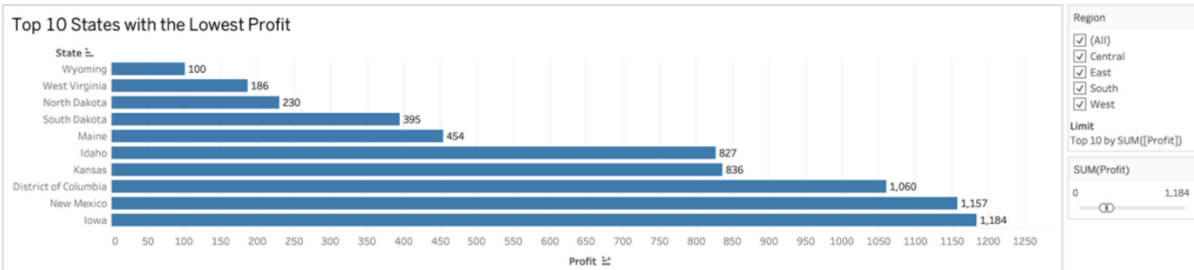

Figure 19: Top 10 States with the Lowest Profit

5.3 States with Negative Profit

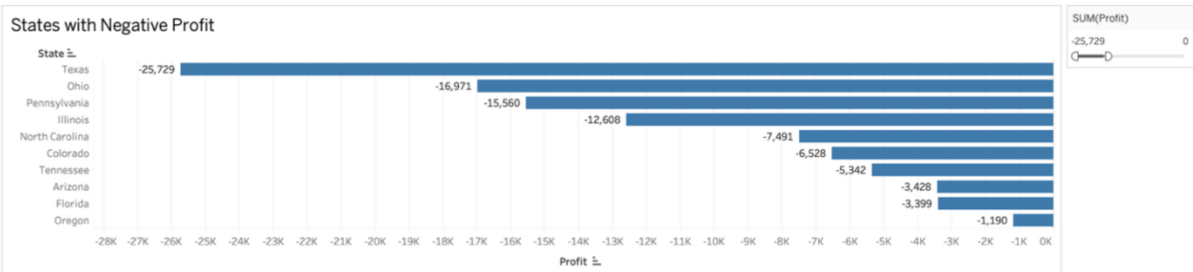

Figure 20: States with Negative Profit

5.4 States with Positive Profit

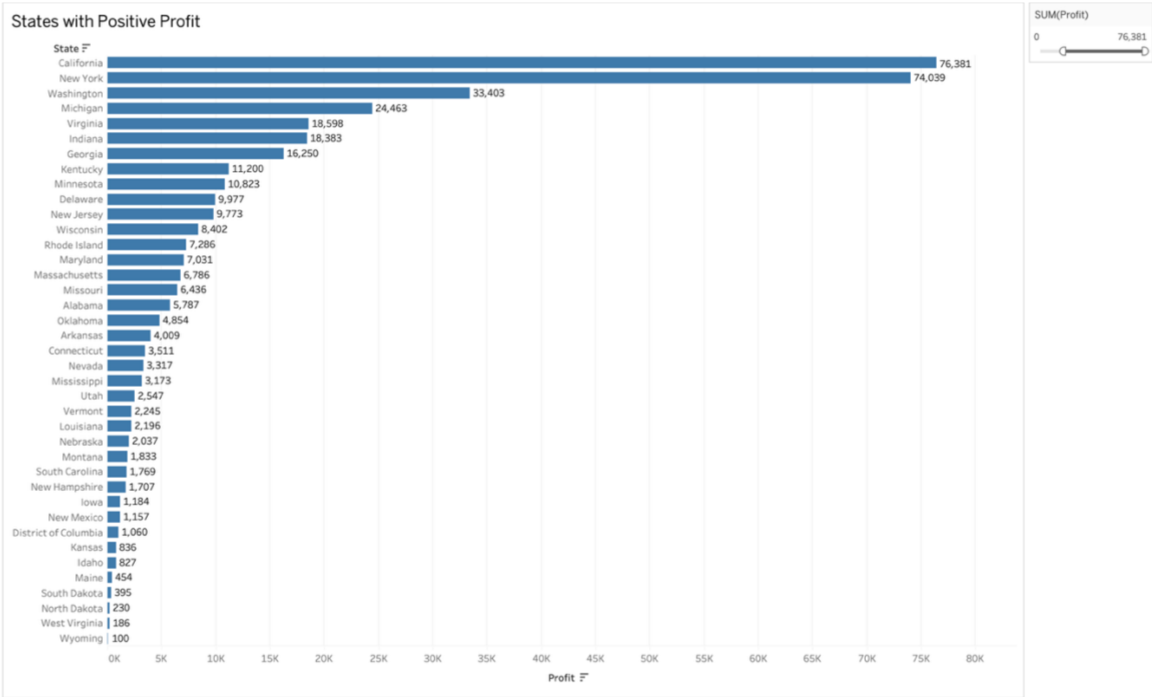

Figure 21: States with Positive Profit

5.5 Summary and Analysis of Profit Based on State

Table 7: Table of Profit Based on States

No	States with Positive Profit	Top 10 States with the Highest Profit	Top 10 States with the Lowest Profit	States with Negative Profit
1	California, New York, Washington, Michigan, Virginia, Indiana, Georgia, Kentucky, Minnesota, Delaware, New Jersey, Wisconsin, Rhode Island, Maryland, Massachusetts, Missouri, Alabama, Oklahoma, Arkansas, Connecticut, Nevada, Mississippi, Utah, Vermont, Louisiana, Nebraska, Montana, South Carolina, New Hampshire, Iowa, New Mexico, District of Columbia, Kansas, Idaho, Maine, South Dakota, North Dakota, West Virginia, Wyoming	California	Wyoming	Texas
2		New York	West Virginia	Ohio
3		Washington	North Dakota	Pennsylvania
4		Michigan	South Dakota	Illinois
5		Virginia	Maine	North Carolina
6		Indiana	Idaho	Colorado
7		Georgia	Kansas	Tennessee
8		Kentucky	District of Columbia	Arizona
9		Minnesota	New Mexico	Florida
10		Delaware	Iowa	Oregon

An analysis of profit distribution across the United States reveals a notable disparity in financial performance among states. Out of the total states observed, 39 states recorded positive profit, while 10 states experienced negative profit, highlighting a significant concentration of economic success in specific regions.

California, New York, and Washington emerged as the top three most profitable states, consistently leading in national rankings. These states are characterized by robust economies driven by technology, finance, and high-value services, which likely contribute to their strong profit margins. Other high-performing states include Michigan, Virginia, and Georgia, representing a mix of industrial strength and growing commercial activity.

In contrast, Wyoming, West Virginia, and the Dakotas are positioned at the bottom of the profit rankings. These states often have smaller populations and economies more reliant on resource extraction or agriculture, which may not yield as high returns as service or tech-driven industries. The presence of New Mexico, Maine, and Idaho in the low-profit segment further supports this trend, reflecting the challenge of scaling profitability in rural or less industrialized regions.

A particularly striking insight is the inclusion of Texas, Ohio, and Pennsylvania in the list of states with negative profit. Despite being among the most populous and economically significant states, their presence in the loss-making group suggests potential inefficiencies, high operating costs, or market saturation in key sectors. This divergence underscores the importance of not equating population size or GDP with profitability without examining operational dynamics and cost structures.

Moreover, the data suggests that regional patterns play a crucial role in profit outcomes. States along the coasts, especially the West Coast and Northeast, dominate the top ranks, while inland and Southern states are more commonly associated with low or negative profits. This points to broader socioeconomic and infrastructural differences that influence business viability and revenue sustainability.

In summary, the data offers valuable insights into the financial health of each state, emphasizing where economic development efforts may be yielding results and where additional support or strategic rethinking may be necessary. Identifying and addressing the root causes behind the low profit in certain states could help drive more balanced national growth and economic resilience.

6. Annual Profit Trends by Country and Region

6.1 Profit by Year of United State

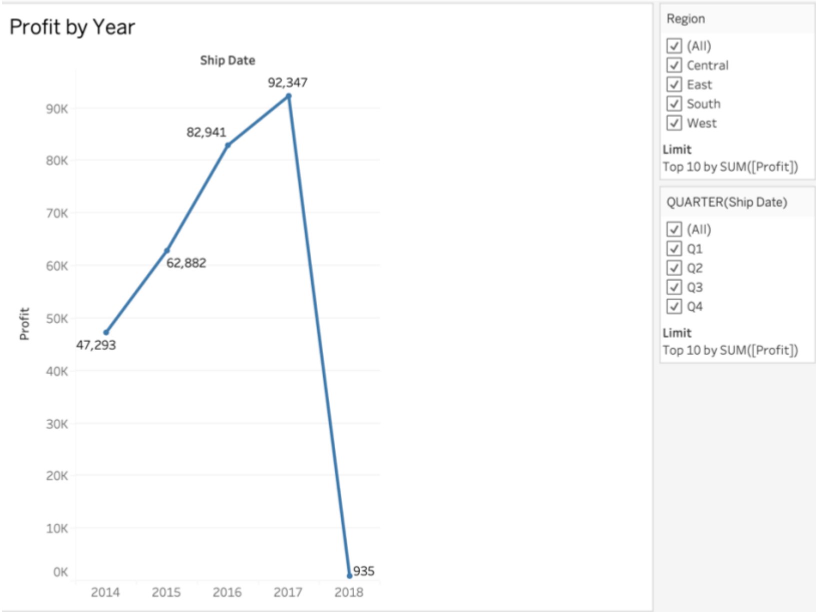

Figure 22: Profit by Year of US from 2014-2018

An analysis of profit by year across the United States from 2014 to 2017 shows a clear upward trend, with national profit increasing steadily from $47,293 in 2014 to $92,347 in 2017. This consistent growth reflects a period of nationwide economic expansion and business performance improvement. While 2018 data for national-level profit is not provided, the regional breakdown offers further insight.

6.2 Annual Profit by Region

6.2.1 Annual Profit of the Central Region

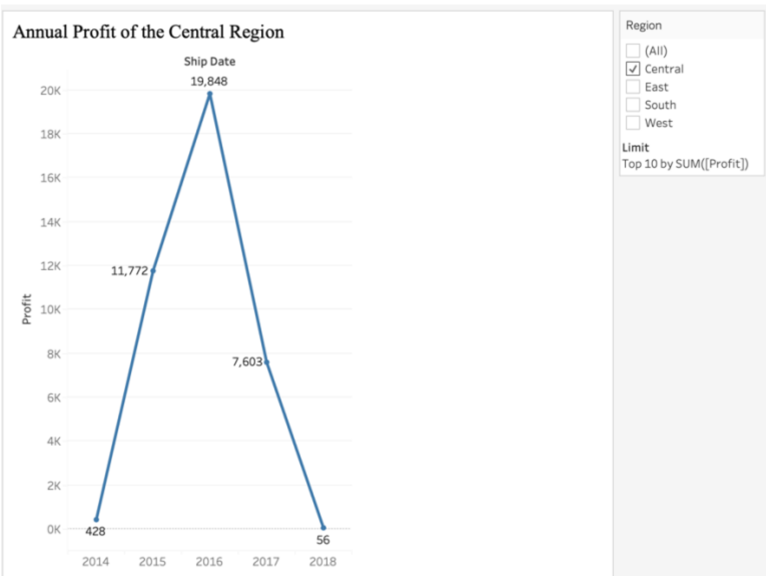

Figure 23: Annual Profit of the Central Region

6.2.2 Annual Profit of the East Region

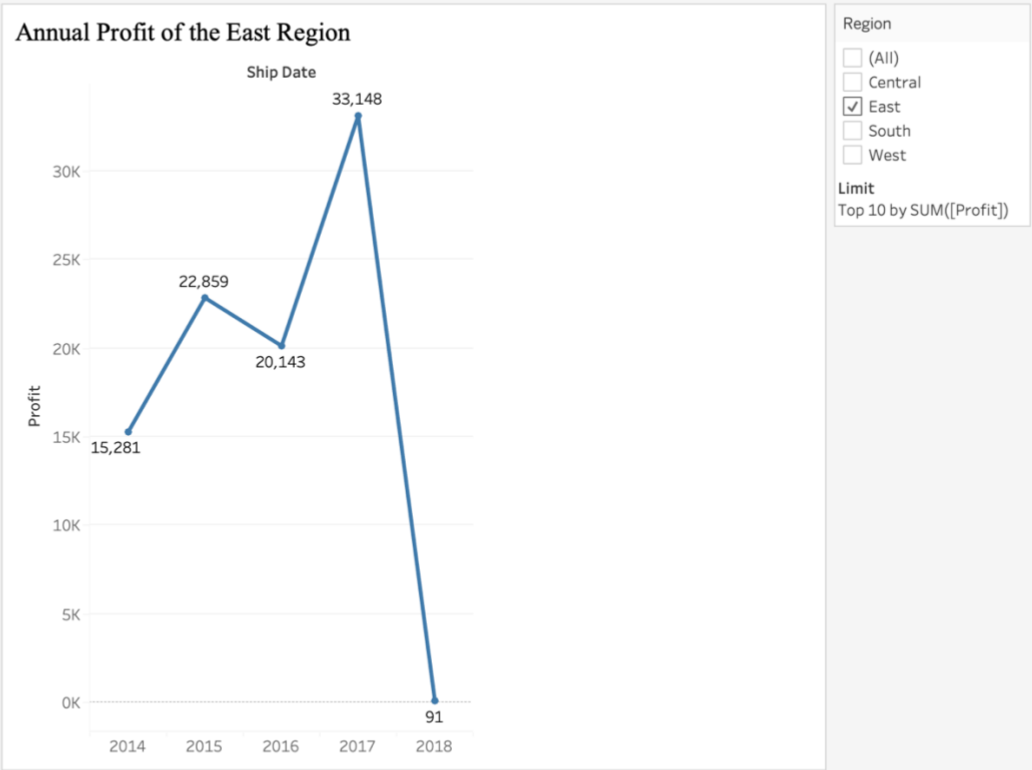

Figure 24: Annual Profit of the East Region

6.2.3 Annual Profit of the South Region

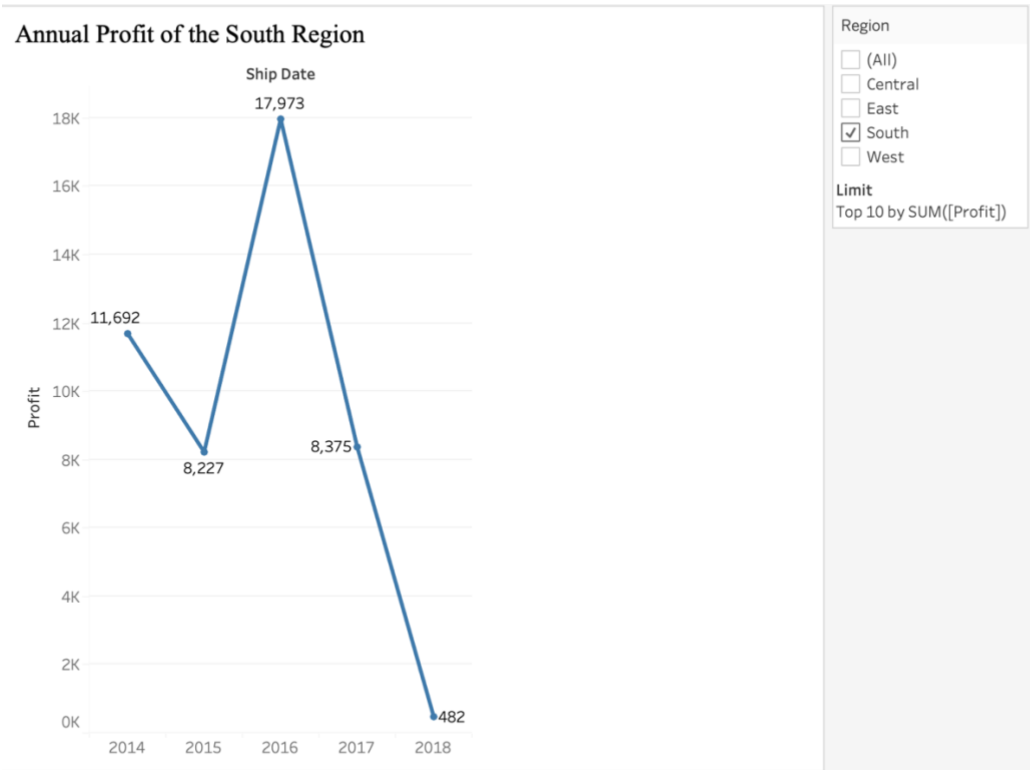

Figure 25: Annual Profit of the South Region

6.2.4 Annual Profit of the West Region

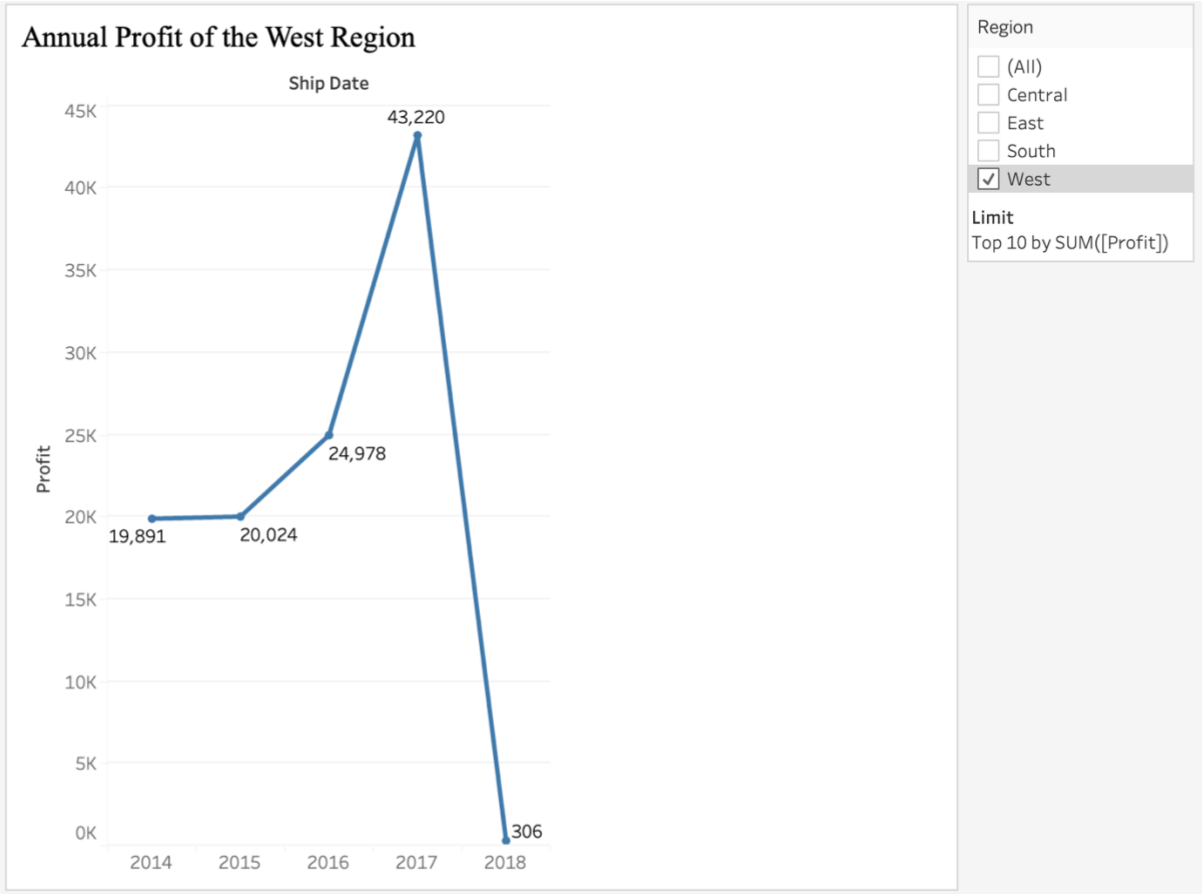

Figure 26: Annual Profit of the West Region

Across all regions—Central, East, South, and West—each year from 2014 to 2018 shows positive profit, indicating no losses at the regional level during this period. However, the scale and consistency of profitability vary significantly by region.

Table 8: Total Regional Profit (2014–2018)

Region	Total Profit (USD)
West	108,419
East	91,522
South	46,749
Central	39,707

The West region consistently outperformed all others, generating the highest cumulative profit. This is likely driven by strong economic activity in states such as California and Washington. The East region follows closely, also showing stable growth with a peak in 2017. In contrast, the Central and South regions showed more volatility, with the Central region experiencing a dramatic drop in 2018 to just $56, after peaking at nearly $20,000 in 2016.

Table 9: Regional Profit in Peak Year (2017)

Region	Profit in 2017 (USD)
West	43,220
East	33,148
Central	7,603
South	8,375

2017 marked the most profitable year for all regions, especially the West, which earned more than five times the profit of the Central region that same year. This reinforces the economic dominance of Western states, particularly those with strong technology, logistics, and service sectors.

While all regions consistently reported positive profit from 2014 to 2018—indicating stable nationwide business viability—the extent and stability of that profitability varied significantly. The West and East regions demonstrated strong and consistent growth throughout the period, reinforcing their positions as economic powerhouses likely supported by high-performing industries such as technology, finance, and logistics. In contrast, the Central and South regions experienced greater volatility, with profits peaking mid-period but declining sharply by 2018. Notably, 2018 marked a substantial drop in profit across all regions, with figures such as $91 in the East and only $56 in the Central, which deviates sharply from prior trends. This widespread downturn may point to a broader macroeconomic disruption or structural adjustment during that year. However, without additional contextual data, the underlying cause remains speculative. Nonetheless, the contrast in performance trajectories highlights the importance of regional economic resilience and the need for differentiated policy or investment strategies to sustain balanced growth across the U.S.

In conclusion, the U.S. demonstrated steady profit growth nationally from 2014 to 2017, with regional performance led by the West and East. However, the Central and South regions show more volatility and less resilience, highlighting the need for region-specific strategies to ensure balanced economic development. The sharp drop in 2018 profitability across all regions may warrant further investigation into macroeconomic or operational factors affecting that year.

7. Recommendation

Below is a comprehensive dashboard titled "Sales and Profit Analysis across US Regions and States (2014–2018)". It consists of multiple visual components, including:

A bar chart illustrating total revenue by region,

A line chart showing annual profit trends across all regions, and

Four individual line charts displaying annual profit by region (West, Central, South, and East).

This dashboard offers a clear overview of regional sales performance and profitability trends over a five-year period, providing key insights for strategic decision-making.

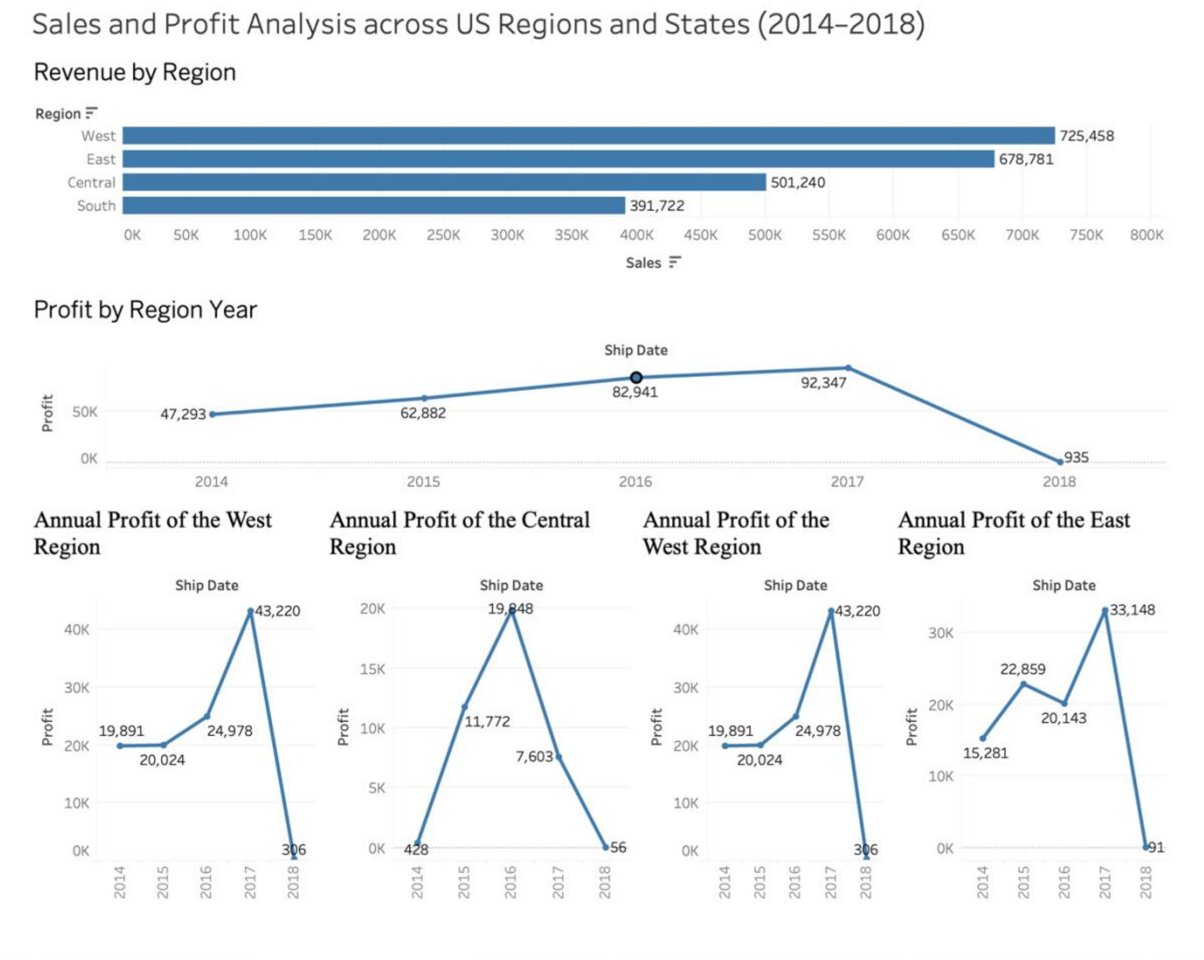

Figure 27: Sales and Profit Analysis across US Regions and States (2014–2018) dashboard

The dashboard reveals that the West and East regions are the primary revenue drivers, generating $725K and $678K respectively. Despite steady profit growth from 2014 to 2017, a sharp decline in 2018 across all regions signals a critical performance issue—likely driven by increased operational costs or margin compression.

Regionally, the West showed the strongest profitability until 2017, while the Central and South lagged consistently, suggesting inefficiencies or weaker market penetration. Notably, profit in 2018 dropped nearly to zero in all regions, despite sustained sales volume.

Strategic Recommendations:

- Audit 2018 operations to identify root causes of the profit collapse.
- Reinforce high-performing regions (West, East) through targeted retention and expansion strategies.
- Reposition underperforming regions (Central, South) with cost optimization and market engagement efforts to close the performance gap.

8. Conclusion

This Tableau-based analysis of the U.S. Superstore dataset (2014–2018) provides comprehensive insights into regional sales performance, state-level disparities, and product-level profitability across the country. The findings consistently highlight the West and East regions as the top revenue and profit generators, while the Central and South regions lag behind, exhibiting signs of market inefficiency and limited profitability.

At the state level, California and New York emerge as dominant contributors, whereas smaller states or those with rural economies, such as Wyoming, North Dakota, and Maine, show limited sales and even negative profit. The product-level analysis further emphasizes strong demand for office equipment, particularly items like the Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier, while outdated products such as DVDs and rubber bands repeatedly rank among the worst performers.

A notable and alarming trend is the sharp decline in profit across all regions in 2018, despite relatively stable sales volume. This suggests either a structural change in cost drivers, pricing models, or external economic shocks. The pattern underlines the importance of monitoring operational efficiency alongside sales performance to ensure sustainable growth.

In summary, the analysis underscores the value of visual analytics using Tableau in uncovering hidden trends, guiding regional strategy, and optimizing inventory. To remain competitive and profitable, businesses must tailor their approach to high- and low-performing regions, modernize their product portfolio, and investigate anomalies such as the 2018 downturn.